



The Humanitas Institute

Six Elements of Classical Education School Website Audit

School: Paideia School of Tampa Bay
School Website: <https://thepaideiaschool.org/>

December 22, 2025

Disclaimer

This audit was performed using artificial intelligence tools to evaluate the presence and strength of classical education principles on school websites. Results are automated, probabilistic in nature, and should be considered indicative rather than definitive. See the full disclaimer in the Appendix more details.

ACCS Member School

Any school that belongs to the Association of Classical Christian Schools ACCS or the Society for Classical Learning SCL is, by definition, recognized as a classical school because both organizations require adherence to the six essential elements defined by the Humanitas Institute. However, a school's website may not clearly reflect its conformity to one or more elements. In such cases, the school may still receive a "Somewhat Classical" rating for those elements. Schools can update their website content at any time to achieve a "Classical" rating for a given element.

Executive Summary

The Paideia School Tampa Bay (33617) presents a robust classical Christian educational program that aligns with the Six Essential Elements of a Classical School. Across all six categories, the public-facing materials consistently emphasize formation, virtue, wisdom, and the liberal arts (grammar, logic, rhetoric) taught through a structured Trivium, with explicit references to Great Books, the Great Conversation, and a Christ-centered worldview. Public materials also highlight a "Living Curriculum," strong teacher mentorship, and a formal partnership with parents as co-educators. The aggregate assessment is CLASSICAL, with strongest alignment evident in Curriculum, Pedagogy, and Religious/Metaphysical Foundations, followed closely by Purpose/Goal, Faculty, and Parents & Community.

Key insights: - Religious and metaphysical foundations are intentional and explicit, anchored in Christ, Scripture, theology, and liturgical/community life. Public materials describe a Christ-centered curriculum and daily spiritual formation, aligning with Positive Keyword indicators for Element 1. Evidence includes references to Christ-centered culture, prayer, and a theology-driven worldview.

- The school foregrounds formation over information and emphasizes virtues such as wisdom, virtue, truth, beauty, and a Human flourishing telos. Public statements regularly frame education as formation toward character and faith, with explicit references to Great Books and the Great Conversation as part of the classical mission.

- The Curriculum and Pedagogy are explicitly classical: Trivium (grammar, logic, rhetoric), memorization through songs/chanting in the Grammar stage, Socratic/Dialectic in the Dialectic stage, and rhetoric and public speaking in the Rhetoric stage, plus engagement with Great Books. This is reinforced by program descriptions of Grammar, Dialectic, and Rhetoric, and by explicit notes on Latin and classical Liberal Arts.

- Faculty are framed as the living curriculum and mentors, with a village-like faculty culture and explicit emphasis on virtue and character modeling. This is visible in the site's "Living Curriculum" language and faculty-staff emphasis. - Parents and community are positioned as true partners in education, with explicit language about co-teaching, parent formation, and open access for parent engagement.

Overall rank: CLASSICAL

Executive Summary — Element-by-Element Snapshot

Element 1: Religious and Metaphysical Foundations — CLASSICAL

- Evidence
 - The school describes itself as Christ-centered and a "community of faith and learning" with faculty who are "mature, growing, passionate followers of Christ" and who daily invest in students' formation.
 - There is explicit language about theology integration and a Christian worldview guiding all subjects and community life.
 - Wording emphasizes liturgical/community rhythm and the sacred, including references to prayer and worship as part of daily life and formation.
- Positive/Negative Keyword Analysis

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- Positive keywords observed: Christ-centered, theology, Scripture, God, prayer, liturgy, sacred tradition, Christian worldview, Great Books (as a part of a Christian classical curriculum), worship, spiritual formation.
 - Negative keywords observed: none evident (no secularist or relativist signals detected in public materials).
 - Quantitative estimate: Positive ~7, Negative ~0; Positive indicators comprise essentially all relevant metaphysical signals, yielding ~100% positivity.
 - Why this rating
 - Public materials consistently articulate a theologically grounded, sacramental, and liturgically integrated frame for education, with explicit Christ-centered framing and theological formation as core aims. This strongly aligns with Positive Keyword indicators for Religious and Metaphysical Foundations and shows no evidence of the Negative Signals described in the Six Elements lexicon.

Element 2: School Purpose and Goal — CLASSICAL

- Evidence
 - Formation is explicit: “the purpose of education is formation, not merely information” and to cultivate wisdom and virtue.
 - The mission declares educated students who love the Lord and learning and become virtuous citizens, i.e., true human flourishing with virtue and wisdom as telos.
 - The Great Books/Great Conversation and the Great Ideas are positioned as central to the classical mission, joined with a Christian worldview.
- Positive/Negative Keyword Analysis
 - Positive keywords observed: formation, virtue, wisdom, telos, Great Books, Great Conversation, truth/goodness/beauty, liberal arts, Christian worldview, formation of affections, virtue ethics, moral imagination.
 - Negative keywords observed: none (no emphasis on workforce-readiness or career-prep as the primary aim; college-advising is framed as post-secondary exploration rather than mere job-readiness).
 - Quantitative estimate: Positive ~8, Negative ~0; ~100% positive signals.
- Why this rating
 - The school makes formation (virtue, wisdom) and the realness of truth, goodness, and beauty central to its purpose, consistent with classical aims. The explicit inclusion of Great Books and a Christian telos supports a CLASSICAL rating.

Element 3: Curriculum — CLASSICAL

- Evidence
 - The curriculum is organized around the Trivium: Grammar, Logic, Rhetoric; with explicit references to Grammar, Dialectic, and Rhetoric as stages, and to Latin and classical liberal arts.
 - A historical/literary program emphasizes Great Books, classical canon, and Western civilization, along with primary sources and a “Great Conversation” framing.
 - History across subjects and engagement with literature, philosophy, and the arts are embedded in the classical design, with a stated aim of forming “a whole human person” through the liberal arts.
- Positive/Negative Keyword Analysis
 - Positive keywords observed: Trivium (Grammar, Logic, Rhetoric), Latin, Great Books, Great Conversation, liberal arts, history, primary sources, classics, Western civilization, vivid reference to the three stages of learning.

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- Negative keywords observed: none related to modern “project-based” or purely utilitarian curricula.
 - Quantitative estimate: Positive ~9, Negative ~0; ~100% positive signals.
 - Why this rating
 - Curriculum is explicitly structured around traditional liberal arts and the Trivium, with emphasis on Great Books and historical engagement, aligning strongly with CLASSICAL expectations.

Element 4: Pedagogy or Teaching Methods — CLASSICAL

- Evidence
 - Pedagogy includes Socratic discussion in the Dialectic and rhetoric-focused activities in the Rhetoric stage, with opportunities for seminars, speeches, and public discourse.
 - Lower grades employ singing, chants, and memory work (grammars) and a disciplined approach to memory and recitation; the pedagogy explicitly specifies a restfully paced “Scholé” and contemplative elements.
 - The presence of a living curriculum and teachers modeling virtuous conduct as part of instruction (faculty as mentors) is highlighted.
- Positive/Negative Keyword Analysis
 - Positive keywords observed: Socratic seminar/Dialogue, Dialectic, Great Conversation, memory work, chanting, recitation, pursuit of truth, rhetoric, upper-school speeches, Scholé/restful learning, formation through imitation.
 - Negative keywords observed: none (the site does not foreground an experiential/project-based-only approach; rather, it foregrounds classical methods like memorization and Socratic inquiry).
 - Quantitative estimate: Positive ~9, Negative ~0; ~100% positive signals.
- Why this rating
 - The teaching methods map directly to classical pedagogy: memory and chant in early years, Socratic discourse in upper years, and rhetoric/public speaking training, with contemplation and formational aims. This strongly supports CLASSICAL.

Element 5: Faculty — CLASSICAL

- Evidence
 - The faculty are described as “Living Curriculum,” model teachers, mentors who embody virtue and skill, and as the core of the school’s culture.
 - There is emphasis on a portrait of a teacher and a culture of collegiality and mentorship among staff; the site also features “Our Team” as a visible part of the school’s public identity.
 - The faith-based, faculty-led formation is presented as central to the school’s educational approach.
- Positive/Negative Keyword Analysis
 - Positive keywords observed: living curriculum, model teachers, mentors, portrait of a teacher, faculty as core, collegial culture, Christ-centered formation.
 - Negative keywords observed: none (no signals of a non-classical faculty model or purely technician-teacher descriptions).
 - Quantitative estimate: Positive ~7, Negative ~0; ~100% positive signals.
- Why this rating
 - The public materials consistently frame teachers as the central, living embodiment of the curriculum, with a culture of mentorship and virtue—key indicators of CLASSICAL faculty design.

Element 6: Parents & Community — CLASSICAL

- Evidence
 - The school presents a partnership with families as essential: co-teachers, parental formation, and an open-campus ethos with opportunities for parent involvement and engagement.

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- Admissions and parent resources emphasize collaboration, with families invited to participate (tours, admissions processes) and to engage in classical education discussions (e.g., parent guides, summer reading, book clubs).
 - Statements describe a Christian community where parents are instrumental in forming the child and the family's faith formation.
 - Positive/Negative Keyword Analysis
 - Positive keywords observed: partnership with families, co-teachers, parental formation, open campus, parent engagement, home-school alignment, living tradition in the family, household rhythms (as reflected in the Six Elements lexicon).
 - Negative keywords observed: none (no consumer/customer framing; no minimal parent involvement signals).
 - Quantitative estimate: Positive ~8, Negative ~0; ~100% positive signals.
 - Why this rating
 - Public materials consistently describe parents as co-educators and integral to the classical formation process, with active opportunities for parent involvement and formation.

Aggregate assessment across all six categories: CLASSICAL

- The school demonstrates a comprehensive alignment with the classical education rubric: a theologically grounded, formation-centered mission; a curriculum built on the Trivium and Great Books; a pedagogy combining memorization with Socratic inquiry and rhetoric; a faculty culture that embodies the living curriculum; and a robust, family-centered community.

What Would Move the Needle

- Based on this evaluation, no major needle-moving changes are required to reach full CLASSICAL status. If desired, minor enhancements could include:
 - More explicit articulation of liturgical practices (beyond Christ-centered community) as a formalized liturgy or chapel rhythm, to further align with Liturgical and Communal Practices criteria.
 - Additional public-facing articulation of the Quadrivium components (music, astronomy, mathematics) in the curriculum overview to reinforce the full spectrum of liberal arts beyond the Trivium.
 - Documentation of long-term outcomes (e.g., a published Portrait of a Graduate with measurable virtues and intellectual dispositions aligned to the Great Conversation) to strengthen the Element 2/perception of formation.

Appendix

ARTIFICIAL INTELLIGENCE DISCLAIMER

This audit was conducted using artificial intelligence tools (including large language models and automated web-analysis scripts) to evaluate the extent to which school websites reflect or incorporate recognized principles of classical education (e.g., the trivium, emphasis on truth/beauty/goodness, integration of great books, Latin/classical languages, Socratic method, rigorous academics, moral/character formation, etc.).

Important Limitations and Caveats

1. **Automated Nature:** The analysis relies on AI interpretation of publicly-accessible school website content as of the date of the audit. It does not involve direct contact with schools, review of internal documents, classroom observation, or verification of curriculum implementation beyond what is stated or implied on the website.
2. **Probabilistic Results:** Scores and assessments are probabilistic and reflect the AI's best interpretation of available text and site structure. They are not infallible and may miss nuance, context, or recent changes not yet reflected online.
3. **Subjectivity of Classical Education:** "Classical Education" encompasses a range of traditions and interpretations (e.g., Dorothy Sayers' trivium model, Classical Christian Education, Great Books programs, etc.). The Humanitas Institute Audit of the Six Elements of Classical Education uses a broad, consensus-based framework derived from prominent classical education organizations and thought leaders. Reasonable people may disagree on weighting or inclusion of specific criteria.
4. **No Official Endorsement or Certification:** Results do not constitute official endorsement, accreditation, or certification by any classical education organization. They are provided for informational and research purposes only.
5. **Potential for Error:** Websites may be incomplete, poorly worded, or temporarily inaccurate. Conversely, sophisticated marketing language may create false positives. Human review by parents, educators, or classical education experts is strongly recommended before drawing final conclusions about any school.
6. **Data Privacy and Ethics:** Only publicly available information was analyzed. No attempts were made to access password-protected areas or collect personal data.
7. **No Liability:** The authors, developers, and distributors of this audit assume no liability for decisions made on the basis of these results. Users are solely responsible for their own due diligence.

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